

# Sweta Rijal

Ph.D. Candidate - ABD she/her

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## Education

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Ph.D., Political Science<br><b>University of California, Irvine</b> | 2021–Present |
| M.A., Political Science<br><b>University of California, Irvine</b>  | 2025         |
| B.A., International Relations<br><b>Wesleyan College, Macon, GA</b> | 2021         |

## Research Interests

Artificial Intelligence, AI Ethics, Technology Policy, International Political Economy, Geopolitics of Emerging Technologies, Global Inequality, Global South

## Dissertation Committee

Dr. Robert M. Uriu (chair)  
Dr. Erin Lockwood (co-chair)  
Dr. Kamal Sadiq

## Research Experience

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| <b>IMPACT Scholar, UC Irvine Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation (DTEI)</b><br>Innovative Methods for Pedagogical AI Course Transformation | Jul. 2026–Sep. 2026 |
| <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b> for Prof. Erin Lockwood<br>UC Irvine<br>Economic International Organizations and Assessment of AI Risks            | Jul. 2025–Sep. 2025 |

## Works in Progress

Lockwood, Erin, and **Sweta Rijal**. (2026). Economic International Organizations' Perception of and Response to Artificial Intelligence Risks. Submitted to *Review of International Organizations* (under review)

*From GVCs to GPTs: International Organizations, AI, and the Impacts on Global Inequalities* (2026)

*Access to Justice of Women Migrant Workers: A Case study of Nepal* (2024 - present)

## Teaching Experience

**Guest Lecturer** Jan. 2026  
Saddleback College, CA  
Political Economy of AI (Undergraduate Course)

**Teaching Assistant** Oct. 2021–Present  
School of Social Sciences, UC Irvine  
Courses taught: American Government, World Politics, Global Economy, Writing for POTUS

## Previous Employment

Economic Security Policy Research Intern Jun. 2022–Sep. 2022  
**Intel Corporation**

Intern at Economic Empowerment Unit Jun. 2019–Aug. 2019  
**United Nations Women, Nepal**

Research Intern Jun. 2018–Aug. 2018  
**Institute of Foreign Affairs, Nepal**

## Presentations and Conferences

International Studies Association (ISA) 2026  
International Studies Association (ISA) 2025  
Center for Global Peace and Conflict Studies (CGPACS) 2025  
IEEE Women in Engineering International Leadership Conference 2022

## Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Christine Mirzayan Science & Technology Policy Fellow,  
National Academies of Sciences Selected, 2026  
Dissertation Fellow, UC Institute on Global Conflict and Cooperation 2026-27  
Methods Funding Award, UCI Department of Political Science (\$1200) 2026  
Center for Global Peace and Conflict Studies Research Grant (\$2000) 2025  
Center for Global Peace and Conflict Studies Research Grant (\$2500) 2024  
UC Irvine Dean's Recruitment Fellowship Award (\$5000) 2021  
Wesleyan College Academic Excellence in International Relations 2021

## Academic Service

Graduate Student Representative, Department of Political Science, UC Irvine 2024–25  
Co-organizer, Workshop on Technology and Society, UC Irvine Mar.2025-Jun.2025

## Other

**Programming:** R,  $\text{\LaTeX}$

**Languages:** English: fluent, Nepali: native, Hindi: conversational, Spanish: beginner, French: beginner